

Bhakti Ratnākara :

The Ocean Of Devotion

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1. SANĀTANA GOSVĀMĪ AND THE GIRLS' BRAIDS

(Fifth Wave, verses 754 - 764)

*ahe śrīnivāsa ei vṛkṣera talāya; hoilo ye raṅga tāhā kohiye tomāya
eka dina sanātana govardhana hoite; ethā āilā rūpa raghunāthera dekhite*

"O Śrīnivāsa!", Rāghava Paṇḍita told Śrīnivāsācārya, "I will tell you what pastime took place at the base of this tree! One day Sanātana Gosvāmī came here (to Rādhākuṇḍa) from Govardhana to see Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha Dāsa Gosvāmī!" (754-5)

śrī rūpa gosvāmī padya koroye racanā; veṇīra upamā dilo vyālāṅganā phanā

sanātana gosvāmī dekhiyā kichu koy; dilā e upamā - ihā hoy vā nā hoy

"Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī had written a verse in which he compared Śrīmatī Rādhārānī's braid with the hoods of a female snake. Seeing this verse, Sanātana Gosvāmī said: "I don't know if this is a good comparison or not!" (756-7)

*eto kohi' āsiyā nāmilā kuṇḍajale; dekhaye - bālikāgaṇa khele vṛkṣatale
bālikā mastake veṇī pīṭhete loṭāya; sanātana dekhe - sarpa-bhrama hoilo tāy
bālikāgaṇa prati kohe ati vyaghra hoiyā; māthāya caḍhaye sarpa pṛṣṭhadeśa diyā
abodha bālikāgaṇa hāo sāvadhāna!; eto kohi nivārite korilā payāna*

"Saying this, he went down to the lake and saw (reflected) in the water that some girls were playing under a tree. When Sanātana Gosvāmī saw the braids of these girls, that hung down their backs, he mistook them for snakes. Very anxiously he told the girls: "O stupid girls! Be careful! Snakes are crawling up your backs!", and ran up to them to stop these snakes. Seeing that Sanātana Gosvāmī was very upset, the girls giggled and disappeared!" (758-62)

*sanātana atisaya vyākula dekhiyā; antardhāna hoilā sobe īṣat hāsiyā
sanātana vihvala hoilā ekhāne; sthira hoiyā gelā rūpa gosvāmīra sthāne
rūpe kohe - ye likhilā sei satya hoy; śrī rūpa jānile sanātanera hṛday*

"Here (on the eastern bank of Rādhākuṇḍa) Sanātana Gosvāmī became overwhelmed. After calming down he went to Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī and said: "What you wrote (about the snake) was true!" Śrī Rūpa understood what was on Sanātana's mind (and that he had understood the purport of the verses)." (763-764)

2. GANTHULI GRĀMA AND GULĀL KUṇḍA

The village of Gānthuli lies 3 km. west of the town of Govardhana. Here Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu saw the Gopāla-deity (see Caitanya Caritāmṛta Madhya-līlā chapter 18)

*aiche parikramā kori govardhana diyā; gelena gānthuli grāme ullasita hoiyā
rāghava paṇḍita śrīnivāsa prati koy; kohiye gānthuli grāma nāma yaiche hoy
ethā holi kheli donhe boise simhāsane; sakhī duhun vastre gānthi dilā saṅgopane
simhāsana hoite donhe uṭhilā yokhon; dekhaye bosoye gānthi hāse sakhī-gaṇa
hoilo kautuka ati donhe lajjā pāilā; phāguya loiyā keho gānthi khuli dilā
e hetu gānthuli - e gulāl kuṇḍa jale; ebe phāgu dekhe loka vasantera kāle*

They blissfully proceeded on the *parikramā* of Govardhana Hill until they reached the village of Gānthulī. Here Rāghava Paṇḍita explained to Śrīnivāsa why the village was named Gānthulī. He said: "During the Holi pastimes, Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa sat down on Their throne here and the *sakhīs* secretly went up to Them from behind to tie up Their clothes. Then they sat

down and laughed when the Divine Couple wanted to get up and dance, but were unable to separate because of the knot. Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa became very shy then and one of the *sakhīs* loosened the knot and threw some coloured powder at Them. That is why this village is named Gānthulī (the word is derived from the Sanskrit word *grantha*, which means knot). Even now every spring season people can see that the lake near this village, named Gulāl kuṇḍa (*gulāl* is a colored substance used for celebrating Holi) is filled with colour!"

3. KOKILAVANA

Kokilavana lies on the left side of the road, halfway between Nandagrāma and Kosi, and can only be reached on foot.

*kṛṣṇa mahā kautuki paramānandamoy; kokila saubhāgya hetu se śabde miloy
yāvatera paścime e vana manohara; lakṣa lakṣa kokila kuhare nirantara
eka dina kṛṣṇa ei vanete āsiyā; kokila sadṛśa śabda kore harṣa hoiyā
sakala kokila hoite śabda sumadhura; ye śune bāreka tāra dhairya yāya dūra*

"In great bliss and to the great fortune of the cuckoos Kṛṣṇa sang here just like a cuckoo! This beautiful forest lies west of Yāvata (where Rādhārāṇī lives with Her in-laws) and hundreds and thousands of cuckoos always sing there very beautifully. One day Kṛṣṇa came to this forest and sang there as beautiful as a cuckoo. The patience of anyone who heard His sweet song even once would go far away." (1160-1163)

*jaṭilā kohoye viśākhāre priya-vāṇī; kokilera śabda aiche kabhu nāhi śuni
viśākhā kohoye - ei mo sabhāra mane; yadi koho e kokile dekhi giyā vane*

"With a pleasant voice Jaṭilā, Śrī Rādhikā's mother-in-law, told Viśākhā: "I've never heard such sweet singing of the cuckoos!" Viśākhā said: "That's also what we think! If you will allow us, we will go into the forest to see this cuckoo!" (1164-1165)

*vṛddhā kohe yāo śuni ullāsa aśeṣa; rāi - sakhī saha vane korilā praveśa
hoilo mahā kautuka sukhera sīmā nāi; sakalei āsiyā mililā eka ṭhāi
kokilera śabde kṛṣṇa mile rādhikāre; ei hetu kokilavana kohoye ihāre*

"Old Jaṭilā said: "Allright, go!" Hearing this, Rāi and Her *sakhīs* entered that forest in boundless bliss. In this way Kṛṣṇa managed to meet Śrī Rādhikā by singing like a cuckoo and that is why this forest is named Kokila-vana." (1166-1168)

4. AÑJANAKA

This village lies two miles south of Khadirvana and is sometimes mentioned as being the birthplace of Indulekhā-sakhī.

*ahe śrīnivāsa dekho añjanaka grāma; ethā rādhā-kṛṣṇera vilāsa anupama
śrī rādhikā nija veśa koroye nirjane; hoilā bhūṣita nānā ratnādi bhūṣaṇe
veśa bandhanādi kori añjana porite, akasmāt vaṁśī-dhvani praveśe karṇete
sei kṣaṇe śrī rādhikā sakhī-gaṇa saṅge; ethā āsi kṛṣṇa mililen mahā raṅge*

"Ohe Śrīnivāsa! Behold this village of Añjanaka! Here Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa had a great pastime! Once Śrī Rādhikā privately dressed and ornamented Herself here with different jewels. When She applied Her own eyeliner the sound of Kṛṣṇa's flute suddenly entered Her ear, so She ran to this place with Her girlfriends and very blissfully met Kṛṣṇa there." (1169-1172)

*āgusari āni kṛṣṇa vihvala hoilā; vṛndā viracita puṣpāsane bosāilā
dekhe aṅga sobhā - netre nā dekhe aṣjana; jijñāsīte vṛttānta kohila sakhīgaṇa
rasera āveśe kṛṣṇa añjana loiyā; dilen rādhikā netre mahā harṣa hoiyā
añjanera chale nānā parihāsa koilo; e hetu e sthāna nāma añjanaka hoilo*

"Kṛṣṇa ecstatically seated Rādhikā on a seat of flowers arranged by Vṛndā, but when He beheld Her bodily beauty He saw that She had no mascara on Her eyes. He asked the *sakhīs* what was the matter and then took some mascara and applied it to Rādhikā's eyes in loving ecstasy. Because there was so much fun here about eyeliner (*añjana*) this place is named Añjanaka." (1173-1176)

5. UMRÃO

Umrão lies closest to Chātā, a bigger town in the center of Vraja Maṇḍala.

*chatravane kṛṣṇa rājā kori sakhāgaṇa; rājā ājñā bole kore sarvatra śāsana
madhumaṅgalādi sabe pragalbha vacane; kṛṣṇera dohāi diyā phire vane vane
mahārāja chatrapati nandera kumāra; tāra e rājyete nāi anya adhikāra
yadi keho puṣpa cayanete ethā āise; tabe daṇḍa dibo tare loiyā rājā pāse*

"In Chatravana Kṛṣṇa declared Himself king of Vraja, and His friends went out on His order to control the kingdom. Headed by Madhumaṅgala, they went from forest to forest, boldly declaring Kṛṣṇa the King of Vraja. They said: "Kṛṣṇa, the son of Nanda Mahārāja, is the king, and no-one else but He is in power here! If anyone comes here to pick flowers, we will take that person before the king to be punished!" (1220-1223)

lalitādi sakhī krodhe kohe bāra bār; rādhikāra rājye ke koroye adhikāra

*aiche koto kōhi lalitādi sakhīgaṇa; rādhikāra umrāo koilā seikṣaṇa
umrāo yogya sinhāsane bosī rāi; sakhīgaṇa prati kohe caturdike cāi
more rājye adhikāra kore yāi jana; parābhava kori tāre āno eikṣaṇa*

"But Lalitā and her friends were angry and asked again and again: "Who wants to have any power in Rādhikā's kingdom?" Thus they established Rādhikā's kingdom, by seating Her on a suitable throne and faithfully surrounding Her. Śrī Rādhikā ordered: "Defeat anyone who wants to control My kingdom and bring Him here!" (1224-1227)

*śunī sajjā hoiyā cole yuddha koribāre; vṛndā vinirmīta puṣpa-yaṣṭi loiya kare
sahasra sahasra sakhī cole cāri bhite; subalādi sakhā tāhā dekhe dūra hoite
śrī madhumaṅgala nā kohiya pālāilo; kon sakhī giyā madhumaṅgala dharilo
puṣpamālā diyā hasta bandhana korilā; umrāo pāśe śighra loiya āilā*

"Hearing this, the *sakhīs* dressed themselves and set out for battle, carrying a flower-scepter made by Vṛndā with them. Thousands and thousands of *sakhīs* scattered in all four directions and Subala and other cowboys saw them coming from a distance. Śrī Madhumaṅgala fled without saying anything, but one *sakhī* caught him, bound his hands with a flowergarland and quickly brought him before empress Rādhā."

*dekhi' madhumaṅgala kohoye bāra bār; kāro rājye korāo kāhāra adhikāra
tomā sabā saha daṇḍa dibo se rājāre; yeno yaiche karma āro kabhu nāhi kore
śunī' madhu kohoye koriya muṇḍa heta; aiche daṇḍa koro yāte bhare mora peṭa
umrāo kohe - e peṭārthi brāhmaṇe; chāḍi deho yāuk rājāra sannidhāne*

"Seeing Madhumaṅgala, empress Rādhikā said: "Which king's order carrier are you? I will punish you and all of your companions so that you will never be so bold again!" Hearing this, Madhumaṅgala lowered his head and said: "Punish me in such a way that my belly will become full!" The empress said: "Let this *brāhmaṇa*, who is only interested in his belly, go back to his Lord!" (1232-1235)

*sakhīgaṇa dilā madhumaṅgale chāḍiyā; bandhana sahita madhu colilo dhāiyā
mahā darpe rājā bosī' rājā sinhāsane; madhumaṅgalere kohe - aiche daśā kene
vimarṣa hoiyā madhu kohe bāra bār; tomāra korinu rājā ei phala tāra
teñho umrāo - tāra pratāpa apāra; tumi ki koribe tāra rājye adhikāra*

"So the *sakhīs* let Madhumaṅgala go. He ran away with his hands still bound. When king Kṛṣṇa, who very proudly sat on His throne, saw Madhumaṅgala, He asked him: "How did you end up in this condition?" Madhumaṅgala morosely replied: "You see, this is the result of my trying to maintain Your kingdom! The power of that empress is unlimited! How can You ever usurp Her empire?" (1236-1239)

*ye kandarpa jagatera dhairya-dhana hare; se kandarpa kampe tāra netra-bhaṅgi dvāre
tāhāte mānaho tumi āmāra vacana; nijāṅga samarpi leho tāhāra śaraṇa
kṛṣṇa kohe - madhu ye kohilā sarvopari; tomāre bandhilo duḥka sahite na pāri
madhu kohe - tomāra maṅgala mātṛa cāi; apamāna hoile-o kono duḥka nāi*

"That Cupid, who destroys the patience of everyone in this world, himself shivers when She even blinks with Her eyes, so heed my words and take shelter of Her, offering Your own body to Her!" Kṛṣṇa said: "Madhu, what you say is the best advice! I cannot tolerate to see you suffer in this bondage!" Madhumaṅgala said: "I only desire Your welfare! Although I was dishonoured I don't feel any misery!" (1240-1243)

*eto kōhi kṛṣṇa hasta kori ākarṣaṇa; rādhikāra nikāṭe āise sei kṣaṇa
prāṇanātha gamana dekhiyā sukhe rāi; hoilen adhairya - lajjā sīmā nāi
umrāo veśa rāi ghucāite cāy; sakhi kohe - ei veśe rahibe ethāy
rādhikāra aiche veśa kṛṣṇa' dekhi dūre; hoilo asthira dhairya dharite na pāre*

"Saying this, Madhumaṅgala took Kṛṣṇa by the hand and brought Him at once to Śrī Rādhikā. Seeing the Lord of Her Heart coming, Śrī Rādhikā was very happy and She became impatient. There was no limit to Her bashfulness and She wanted to give up Her royal dress, but Her *sakhis* told Her: "This dress will stay here (You will have to wear it still!)" Seeing Rādhikā's dress from a distance, Kṛṣṇa could not remain calm." (1244-1247)

*kṛṣṇa ceṣṭā dekhi madhu ullāsa hiyāya; rādhikā samīpe kṛṣṇe ānilo tvarāya
rādhikā daksina pāṣe kṛṣṇe bosāilo; kṛṣṇa vāme rāi ki adbhuta śobhā hoilo
rādhikāra prati madhu kohe bāra bār; ebe kṛṣṇa loho rājye koro adhikāra
kṛṣṇa ye diben eka āliṅgana ratna; se tomāra bheta - tā loibe kori yatne*

"Madhumaṅgala was very happy at heart when He saw Kṛṣṇa's condition and He quickly brought Him before Rādhikā, seating Him on Her right side. How beautiful Rādhikā looked, sitting on Kṛṣṇa's left! Again and again Madhumaṅgala told Rādhikā: "Now take Kṛṣṇa (as Your husband) and rule Your empire! The prize You will get for that is His jewel-like embrace! Accept that prize carefully!" (1248-1251)

*śuni madhu vacana lalitā hāsi sukhe; dilena modaka madhumaṅgalera mukhe
madhu kohe koilā doṣa bāndhilā āmāya; aiche lakṣa laḍḍu bhuñjāile doṣa yāya
eto kōhi bhaṅgi kori' modaka bhuṣjaye; sakhi suveṣṭita duṁhe śobhā nirīkṣaye
modaka bhuñjiyā ati sumadhura bhāse; bahu kārya āche - boli coloye ullāse*

"Hearing Madhumaṅgala's words, Lalitā blissfully laughed and put a sweetmeat in his mouth. Madhumaṅgala said: "You have offended me, but you will be forgiven if you give me a hundred thousand *laḍḍus* like that!" Saying that, he made many gestures and ate the sweets,

while gazing at the beauty of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa being surrounded by Their *sakhīs*. While enjoying the sweets, he sweetly said: "I have a lot of things to do!" and blissfully went off.

*umrāo, rājā - donhe nikuñja bhavane; korilā praveśa ati ullasita mane
surata samare donhe śrama yukta hoilā; vividha kautuke sakhī śrama dūra koilā
ahe śrīnivāsa raṅga kohite ki āra; umrāo grāma nāma e hetu ihāra*

"Then the emperor and the empress joyfully entered into a grove cottage. When They became tired of Their lovesports there, the *sakhīs* soothed Them in different expert ways. Ahe Śrīnivāsa! What more can I say about all the fun that went on there? For this reason this village was named Umrāo!" (1256-1258)

6. NARĪ SEMARĪ

*paṇḍita kohoye - narī semarī - e grāme; śyāmarī kinnarī - e grāmera pūrva nāma
rādhikāra māna bhaṅga upāy nā dekhi; eikhāne śrī kṛṣṇa hoilā śyāmā sakhī
vīṇā yantra bājāiṇī āilā ethāy; śrī rādhikā kohe - e kinnarī sarvathāy
śunī vīṇā vādya rāi vihvala hoilā; nija ratna-mālā tāra gale porāilā
kinnarī kohe - māna ratna more deho; anugraha koriyā āpana kori leho
e vākya śunīyā rāi manda manda hāse; dūre gelo māna - magna hoilā ullāse*

Rāghava Paṇḍita said: "This village Narī Semarī was previously called Śyāmarī Kinnarī. One time Śrī Kṛṣṇa found no means to soothe Śrī Rādhikā's proud huff, so He dressed Himself like a *gopī* named Śyāmā-sakhī here, playing a Vīṇā. Śrī Rādhikā, hearing the sound of this Vīṇā, was overwhelmed with joy and said: "This must be a Kinnarī (demigoddess)!" She took Her own jewel necklace and hung it around Śyāmā-sakhī's neck. That Kinnarī then said: "Give Me the jewel of Your pride (give up Your anger towards Me)!" Hearing these words, Rādhikā smiled slightly. Her anger was gone and She was once again immersed in bliss." (1270-1275)

7. PĀVANA SAROVARA

Śrīla Rāghava Paṇḍita describes a pastime of Sanātana Gosvāmī by this celebrated lake near Nandagrāma.

*vṛndāvana hoite āsi' e nirjana vane; premete vihvala sadā kṛṣṇa ārādhane
saṅgopane rahe bhakṣaṇera ceṣṭā nāi; keho nā jānaye - ke āchaye ei ṭhāi*

"Śrīla Sanātana Gosvāmī came from Vṛndāvana to this lonely forest and constantly worshiped Kṛṣṇa here in ecstatic love. He stayed here without even endeavouring to collect any food. No one knew that he was there." (1301-1302)

*kṛṣṇa gopa bālakera chale dugdha loiyā; dāḍāilā gosvāmī sammukhe harṣa hoiyā
go rakṣaka veśa mātṛe uṣṇīśa śobhāya; dugdha bhaṇḍa hāte dhari' gosvāmīre koy
āchaho nirjane tomā keho nāhi jāne; dekhilām tomāre āsiyā gocāraEe
ei dugdha pān koro āmāra kothāy; loiyā yāibo bhāEḍa rākhilo ethāy*

"Kṛṣṇa then came to him dressed as a cowherdboy, blissfully standing before Him with some milk. He had a beautiful turban on His head and a milkpot in His hand as He told Sanātana Gosvāmī: "Nobody knows that you're here all alone! I saw You here when I came here to herd My cows. Please drink this milk! I will pick up the pot later, just keep it here!" (1303-1306)

*kuṭīre rohile mo sabhāra sukha hobe; aiche raho ithe vrajavāsī duḥka pābe
eto kohi' gopālera hoilo gamana; mugdha hoiyā pān koilo sanātana
dugdha pān mātṛe preme adhairyā hoilo; netrajale sikta hoiyā bahu kheda koilā
alakṣite prabhu sanātana prabodhilā; vrajavāsī dvāre eka kuṭīre korāilā
aiche sanātanera hoilo vāsāloy; madhye madhye ethā śrī rūpera sthiti hoy*

"We will all be happy if you would stay in a hut (instead of outside)! If you stay here like this, the people of Vraja will be very sad!" Saying this, Gopāla went away and Sanātana drank the milk in an enchanted state. After he drank, he became overwhelmed with ecstatic love and he sprinkled himself with tears. The Lord secretly addressed Sanātana Gosvāmī and had the people of Vraja make a hut for him. In this way Sanātana Gosvāmī got his own dwellingplace there. Sometimes Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī also stayed there." (1307-1311)

*eka dina śrī rūpa gosvāmī sanātane; bhunjāite dugdhānnādi korilen mane
aiche mane kori punaḥ saṅkocita hoilā; śrī rūpera manovṛtti rādhikā jānilā
ghṛta dugdha taṇḍula śarkarādi loiyā; gopa bālīkāra chale āilā harṣa hoiyā*

"One day Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī thought of feeding Sanātana Gosvāmī (his *guru*) some *kṣīra* (sweet rice). He became hesitant, but Śrī Rādhikā had seen what was on his mind, so She blissfully came before Him as a cowherd girl, bringing *ghī* (clarified butter), milk, rice and sugar with Her." (1312-1314)

*rūpa prati kohe svāmī ei sab leho; śīghra pāk kori kṛṣṇe samarpi bhunjāho
mātā mora ei kothā kohilo kohite; kono-i saṅkoca yeno nāhi kabhu cite
eto kohi śrī rādhikā kautuke colilā; śrī rūpa gosvāmī sukhe śīghra pāk koilā*

"She told Śrī Rūpa: "O Svāmījī! Take all these ingredients, quickly cook for Kṛṣṇa and offer it to Him! My mother told Me to do this, so don't feel shy at all!" After saying this, Śrī Rādhikā joyfully left and Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī blissfully began to cook." (1315-1317)

*kṛṣṇe samarpiyā gosvāmī sanātana; kori pariveśana paramānanda mane
sanātana gosvāmī sāmāgrī sugandhite; nā jāne kautuka sukha upajāya cite
dui eka grāsa mukhe diyā sanātana; hoilā adhairya - āśru nahe nivārana
sanātana sāmāgrī vṛttānta jijñāsilo; śrī rūpa kramete sab vṛttānta kohilo*

"After offering the food to Kṛṣṇa, Rūpa Gosvāmī served it to Sanātana Gosvāmī. I cannot describe Sanātana Gosvāmī's ecstasy when he smelled the nice fragrance of these dishes! After he had eaten one or two mouthfuls, Sanātana became agitated with ecstasy and could not withhold his tears of love. When Sanātana Gosvāmī inquired about the origin of the ingredients, Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī gradually told him everything." (1318-1321)

*śuniyā gosvāmī niṣedhaye bāra bār; aiche bhakṣya dravya ceṣṭā nā koriho ār
eto kōhi' mahā prasāda sevā koilā; śrī rūpa gosvāmī ati kheda yukta hoilā
svapna cchale śrī rādhikā diyā daraśane; prabodhilā śrī rūpe jānilā sanātane*

"Hearing the story, Sanātana Gosvāmī repeatedly forbade Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī to prepare food for which Śrī Rādhikā personally had to come to provide the ingredients. After that he honoured the *prasāda*, leaving Śrī Rūpa repenting his act. Śrī Rādhikā then appeared to Śrī Rūpa in a dream and consoled him. Sanātana Gosvāmī was aware of that (so he did not blame Rūpa Gosvāmī anymore)." (1322-1324)

*ahe śrīnivāsa yaiche rūpera dhairya; vaiṣṇava samāje vyakta hoilo āścarya
eka dina rādhā-kṛṣṇa viccheda kathāte; kāndaye vaiṣṇava murcchāgata pṛthivīte
agni-śikhā prāya jvale rūpera hṛday; tathāpi bāhire kichu prakāśa nā hoy
kāru dehe śrī rūpera niśvāsa sparśilo; agni dagdha prāy tāra dehe braṇa hoilo*

"Ahe Śrīnivāsa! The Vaiṣṇava-world was astonished at the gravity of Rūpa Gosvāmī! One day he felt so much separation from Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa that he cried and fainted, falling on the ground before the Vaiṣṇavas. His heart was as if burning in the high flames of a fire, but still none of this was externally visible. But if Śrī Rūpa's outgoing breath touched anyone's body, that body was burned and caught a blister!" (1325-1328)

8. CARAṆA PĀHĀḌI

At this place, which is just outside of Nandagrāma, on the right side of the road to Kāmyavana, Kṛṣṇa's footprints are visible.

*caraṇa pāhāḍi ei parvatera nāma; ethā kṛṣṇa-candrera kautuka anupama
sakhā suveṣṭita kṛṣṇa cāriyā parbate; gogaṇa carave dūre - dekhe cāri bhite
bhuvana mohana veśe vaṁśī kore loiyā; dāḍāilā vṛkṣatale tribhaṅga hoiyā*

"This hill is named Carana Pāhāḍi. Here Kṛṣṇacandra had lots of fun. Surrounded by His friends He climbed upon the hill and saw His cows grazing everywhere from afar. He took His flute in His hand and stood under a tree in His beautiful threefold bending form and His world- enchanting dress." (1391-1393)

*vamśi vādyārambha mātṛe jagata mātīlo; ye yathā chilēn saba dhāiyā āsilo
vamśi gāna śṛavane sthagita sabe hoilā; tulanā ki gāna - ei parvata dravilā
vamśi dhvani suniyā ye āilo ethāya; tān sabāra pada cihna dekhaho silāya
śrī kṛṣṇera pāda padma cihna e rahilo; ei hetu carana pāhāri nāma hoilo*

"As soon as He began to play His flute, He maddened the whole world, and everyone came running to Him from wherever he was. Everyone was stunned by His flutesong; what can it be compared with? It made even this mountain melt! Just look at all these footprints on this rock! These are the footprints of all those who came to see Kṛṣṇa after hearing His flute song! Because Śrī Kṛṣṇa's lotusfoot prints are here, this place is named Carana Pāhāḍi (the hill with footprints)." (1394-1397)

9. VRNDĀVANA'S CĪRA GHĀṬA

*ahē śrīnivāsa ei cīra ghāṭa hoy; keho vā cayana ghāṭa ihāre kohoy
eka dina rādhā-kṛṣṇa sakhigaṇa saṅge; rāsādi vilāsa ante ethā āilā sthāne
vastrāḍika rakhi ei nīpa vṛkṣa tale; sūkṣma kharva vastra pare nāmīlena jale
hoiyāchilen śrānta vividha vilāse; śrama śrānti hoilo snigdha yamunā paraśe*

"Ohe Śrīnivāsa! This Cīra Ghāṭa (on the bank of the Yamunā) is also called Cayana Ghāṭa by some! One day, at the end of the Rāsa-līlā, Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa came here with Their *sakhis*. They kept Their clothes here under this Kadamba-tree, put on thin short dresses and went into the water. They felt great relief from Their fatigue (of dancing the Rāsa) by touching the Yamunā-water." (2359-2362)

*vāri viharane mahāraṅga upajilo; sakalei giyā padma vane praveśilo
kṛṣṇa kono chaletē āsiyā vṛkṣatale; kori vastra gopana praveśe punaḥ jale
kotokṣaṇe jala keli kori uṭhe tīre; vastra nā dekhiyā sabe cintita antare
kṛṣṇa se samaye adbhuta śobhā heri; dilena sabāre vastra parihāsa kori*

"They had a lot of fun playing in the water and they all entered into a cluster of lotus flowers there. Then Kṛṣṇa, through some trick, came back to the Kadamba-tree, hid the *gopīs*' clothes and went back into the water. The *gopīs* continued their water sports for some time more and then climbed back on the shore again. They became worried when they could not find their clothes back, but Kṛṣṇa returned their clothes after He had admired their amazing beauty. Such are His joking sports!" (2363-2366)

10. ŚRĪLA RŪPA GOSVĀMĪ'S VISION IN VṚNDĀVANA

*eka dina śrī rūpa gosvāmī vṛndāvane; bhāvaye mānase mahā ullasita hoiyā
rādhikāra veśa viracaye sakhīgana; prṣṭha deśe rahi kṛṣṇa kore nirīkṣaṇa
kṛṣṇa ye dekhen tāhā rādhikā nā jāne; jānāite sakhīra kautuka bādhe mane
vicitra bandhane kesa koriyā bandhana; rādhikāra āge sakhī dharilā darpana*

"One day Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī blissfully meditated in Vṛndāvana that the *sakhīs* were dressing Śrī Rādhikā while Kṛṣṇa secretly stood behind them, watching them. Śrī Rādhikā did not notice it, and Kṛṣṇa increased His own pleasure by making His presence known to the *sakhīs* only. After the *sakhīs* had braided Rādhikā's hair with a beautiful string, they held a mirror before Her." (3805-3808)

*śrī rādhikā nija mukha śobhā nirakhite; kṛṣṇa mukhacandra dekhe sei darpaṇete
vyasta hoilen rāi lajjā atisāya; loiyā vasana śighra sarvāṅga jhāpaya
sakhīgana hāse mahā kautuka hoilo; śrī rūpa gosvāmī sei sangei hasilo*

"When Śrī Rādhikā beheld the beauty of Her own face in the mirror, She saw Kṛṣṇa's moonlike face behind Her. She became very shy and quickly took a garment to cover Herself with. When the *sakhīs* saw this fun, they began to laugh and Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī (in his spiritual identity as Śrī Rūpa Mañjarī) laughed with them." (3809-3811)

*heno kāle āilā vaiṣṇava eka jana; śrī rūpe dekhite ati utkaṇṭhita mana
śrī rūpa hāsen dekhi' kichu nā kohilā; vimarṣa hoiyā sanātana āge gelā*

"Just then one Vaiṣṇava came who was eager to see Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī. Śrī Rūpa just laughed without saying anything to that Vaiṣṇava-devotee, so the devotee became displeased and went to Sanātana Gosvāmī." (3812-3813)

*vaiṣṇava kohoye genu śrī rūpa dekhite; āmāre dekhiyā teñho lāgilā hāsite
mano duḥkī hoiyā āre kichu nā kohinu; na bujhi kāraṇa kichu jijñāsīte āinu
ye nimitta hāse tā kohilā sanātana; śunī vaiṣṇavera hoilo kheda yukta mana
vaiṣṇava kohen e samaya keno genu; tāra māna nā bujhiyā aparādha koinu*

"That Vaiṣṇava said: "I went to see Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī, but he only laughed at me! I became sad and I did not say anything, although I came to him to ask him something. I cannot understand why he behaved like that!" So Sanātana Gosvāmī explained that Vaiṣṇava why Rūpa Gosvāmī was laughing. When the Vaiṣṇava heard this, he felt very sorry for misunderstanding Rūpa Gosvāmī in this way and he said: "Why did I go to see him just now? I committed a great offense to him, not understanding his mind!" (3814-3817)

11. ŚRĪLA NAROTTAMA DĀSA ṬHĀKURA'S MENTAL SERVICE AT RĀDHĀKUṆḌA

(Sixth Wave, Verses 168-174)

*eka dina rādhā kṛṣṇa sakhīgaṇa saṅge; vilasaye nikuṇje parama prema raṅge
śrī rādhikā kautuke kohoye sakhī prati; ethā bhakṣya dravya śīghra koro susaṅgati*

"One day Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa were playing in the *nikuṇja* with Their *sakhīs* with great love and Śrī Rādhikā eagerly told Her friends: "Quickly arrange for something to eat here!"

*lalitādi sakhī mahā ullasita hoiyā; bhakṣaṇa sāmāgrī sabe kore yatna pāiyā
narottama dāsi rūpe ati yatna mate; dugdha āvartana kore sakhīra iṅgite*

Lalitā and her *sakhīs* then very blissfully collected the ingredients for the picnic and Narottama Dāsa, in his spiritual body as Rādhikā's maidservant, very carefully stirred the milk on the *sakhīs*' indication." (170-171)

*uṭhali paraye dugdha dekhi vyasta hoilā; culli hoite dugdha pātra haste nāmāilā
hasta dagdha hoilo - tāhā kichu smṛti nāi; dugdha āvartana kori' dilā sakhī ṭhāi
manera ānande rādhā-kṛṣṇe bhunajāilo; avāśeṣa labhya mātṛe bāhya jñāna hoilo*

"He became very upset when he saw that the milk boiled over and he quickly lifted the milkpot from the fire with his hand. In this way he burned his hand, but he was not aware of it and gave the milk to another *sakhī* to stir it. In great joy he mentally offered the milk to Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa and only when They left him Their remnants He returned to external consciousness. (In other words, he burned his material hand, although he was rendering devotional service in a mentally conceived spiritual body)." (172-174)

12. ŚRĪLA SANĀTANA GOSVĀMĪ'S LOVE FOR THE PEOPLE OF VRAJA

*eka grāme rahi' āra grāme yabe jāy; grāmaṁvāsī loka gosvāmīra pāche dhāy
kibā bāla vṛddha — keho dhairya nāhi mane; gosvāmīra vicchede kāndaye sarva jane
sanātana gosvāmī-o krandana koriyā; nija nija grhe pāṭhāyena prabodhiyā
krandana samvari' sobe nija grhe gele; tabe sanātana anya grāme śīghra cole
ye grāme jāibo sei grāmaṁvāsigaṇa; dūre hoite dekhe sanātanera gamana
kibā bāla vṛddha yubā strī puruṣagaṇe; sabe kohe — ei dekho rūpa sanātane*

"When Sanātana Gosvāmī moved from one village to the other, the villagers were running after him. Neither the young or the old could remain calm; all of them wept out of separation from him. Sanātana Gosvāmī would also weep while sending them back home. All the villagers

wept as they returned home, while Sanātana Gosvāmī hurried to the next village. Whatever village Sanātana Gosvāmī visited, the villagers saw him coming from afar. The young, the old, the children, women and men — all said: “Look! There are Rūpa and Sanātana!” (1346-1351)

*vrajavāsigaṇera adbhuta sneha hoy; rūpe dekhile-o rūpa sanātana koy
grāmī lokagaṇa keho sthira hoite nāre; āgusari cole sanātane ānibāre
bahu ratna labhye daridrera sukha yaiche; sanātana darśane sabāra sukha taiche
ativṛddha vṛddha yoto strī puruṣagaṇa; putrabhāve sanātane koroye lālana
kohe keho- are putra! mo sabe bhūliyā; ki rūpe āchilā kothā mori e cintiyā
aiche koiḥsabe sanātana mukha cāi; āpanā nirmañche mone mahāsukha pāi*

“The people of Vraja had a wonderful affection — when they saw only Rūpa Gosvāmī they would still say ‘Rūpa-Sanātana’. None of the villagers could remain calm — they would rush forward to bring Sanātana in, happy to see him, like a poor man who just found many jewels. The old and the very old women and men fondled Sanātana Gosvāmī like their own child. Some would say: “O my son! How could you survive while forgetting us? We die while thinking of this!” Saying this they would look at Sanātana’s face and find great happiness, considering themselves blessed. (1352-1357)

*strī puruṣa vṛddha yuvā — jāra janma se grāmete; tā sabāra bhrātr-bhāva — vihvala snehete
keho kohe — bhrātā tumi āchilā kemone; bujhi mo sabāre kabhu na korilā mone
kene bhrātā ! mo sabāre hoilā nirdaya; aiche koto kohe — netre āsrudhārā boy
bālikā bālaka āse’ caraṇa sparśite; kore nivāraṇa sabe — nāre nivārite
kichu dūre rohiyā grāmera vadhūgaṇa; saṅkocita hoiyā sabe koroye darśana*

“Whoever was born in that village — women, men, young or old — they were all overwhelmed with feelings of fraternal affection. Some said: “Brother, how are you? I understand you never think of us! Why, brother, are you so merciless towards us?” As they spoke like that, tears flowed from their eyes. Girls and boys came to touch his feet. Others tried to stop them, but in vain. The newly married women of the village kept some distance and timidly took his darśana from a distance. (1358-1362)

*ahe śrīnivāsa! sanātanera darśane; praṇāmādi kriyā kāru smṛti nāhi mone
grāme praveśite ye ye āise dhāiyā; haste dhari loiyā cole dṛḍha āliṅgiyā
divya vṛkṣa tale sabe monera ullāse; sanātane bosāi boisoye cāri pāse
dadhi dugdha navanīta ādi grha hoite; āne yatne sabe sanātane bhuñjaite
bhojana kautuka samādhiyā kotokhone; susthira hoiyā sukhe boise sarva jane*

“O Śrīnivāsa! When they saw Sanātana, no one thought of offering formal obeisances to him — in whatever village he entered into they held his hand and firmly embraced him. They all seated him at the base of a divine tree and sat all around him. They carefully brought

yoghurt, milk and butter from their homes and fed it to Sanātana. After completing the tumult of feeding him they calmed down and blissfully sat with him. (1363-1367)

*sanātana gosvāmī parama snehāveśe; sabe sarva prakārei maṅgala jijñāse
kāro koto kanyā putra vivāha kothāy; ki nāma kāhāra kaiche pravīna nirbhāya
gābhī vṛṣādika koto kṛṣīkarma karo; kāro grhe śasya koto kaiche vyavahāro
śārīra ayogyā kō kaiche manovṛtti; aiche jijñāsīte sabe hon harṣa ati
gosvāmīte krame sabe sab nivedaya; kāru duḥka śunitei mahā duḥkī hoyā
sanātana prabodhe tāhāra duḥka khoy; ei sab prasaṅge rātri prabhāta koroya*

(Although Sanātana Gosvāmī was most renounced, his love for the people of Vraja transcended all his rules of renunciation and out of great love for them he would speak about worldly subjects with them all night). "Most affectionately Sanātana Gosvāmī inquired from the Vrajavāsīs about their welfare: How many sons and daughters do you have and where are they married? What are their names and how do they live? How much harvest you collected in your house and how much ploughing have you done? Are you physically unwell? How do you feel mentally?" The Vrajavāsīs were all very happy when he asked these things from them and they gradually informed him of everything. If anybody was suffering that would make Sanātana Gosvāmī very unhappy. Sanātana would then mitigate their distress by speaking to them. In this way they passed the whole night, speaking until sunrise." (1368-1373)

*prāte prātaḥ kriyā śīghro kori sanātana; snānādika koritei āise sarva jana
dadhi dugdhādika sabe śīghro ānayay; sanātana gosvāmīre bhuñjite kohoy
bhuñjena śrī gosvāmī sabāre bhuñjāiyā; dekhaye sabāra śobhā ullasita hoiyā
pūrva mata grāma hoite korite gamana; vyākula hoiyā kānde vrajavāsigaṇa
yaiche snehacaryā — tā kohite anta nāi; vividha prakāre sabe prabodhe gosāi*

Sanātana Gosvāmī then quickly went to do his morning duties; after his bath all the villagers came out quickly to serve him milk and yoghurt. They told Sanātana Gosvāmī to eat and he also fed all of them. When he saw how beautiful they were he was very happy. Like before, the Vrajavāsīs were very upset when he left the village. There is no end to the narrations of their affection — Sanātana Gosvāmī addressed them in various ways. (1374-1378)

*katho dūre saṅge sabe gamana korite; den nija śapatha sabāre phirāite
ei rūpe grāme grāme koriyā bhramaṇa; aisen **baithān grāmete** sanātana
sanātane dekhiyā grāmera loka joto; ye ānande magna — tā kohibe kebā koto
sanātana sabāra maṅgala jijñāsoy; gowāyen divā niśi ullāsa hiyāy
eka rātri vāsa — e nirbandha sabe jāne; hoiyā vyākula tei kohe sanātane
kotho din thākile sabāra bhālo hoy; māno tā sabāra kothā nā hao nirday
prātaḥ kāle jābe ei nirbandha tomāra; chāḍaho nirbandha — prāṇa rākhoho sabāra
aiche grāmavāsī koto kohen kāndiyā; e hetu rohilo ethā sabe sukha diyā*

baiṭhān grāmīya āra nikāṭastha joto; sabe sanātana guṇe magne avirata

They would all follow him for a long way until he swore them to return. In this way Sanātana wandered from village to village until he arrived at **Baiṭhān village**. Seeing Sanātana all the villagers were immersed in indescribable bliss. Sanātana inquired from all about their welfare and spent a day and a night there with a happy heart. Everyone knew that Sanātana had taken a vow just to stay for one day and one night at one place, but still they anxiously begged him: “Everyone will be so happy if you would stay for some days. Please heed our plea and don’t be cruel to us. According to your vow you will leave us the next morning — please give up your vow and save our lives.” Thus the villagers spoke to him and wept and he felt compelled to stay [for a while] to the joy of all. All the villagers of Baiṭhān and the surrounding area were always immersed in the glorious attributes of Sanātana Gosvāmī. (1379-1387)

13. ŚRĪLA RAGHUNĀTHA DĀSA GOSVĀMĪ AND THE TIGERS.

*eka dina sanātana vṛndāvana hoite; ethā āilā śrī gopāla bhaṭṭera vāsāte
mānasa pāvana ghāṭe colilen snāne dekhe; eka vyaghra jala piye seikhāne
raghunātha dhyānāveśe āchen bosiyā; vyāghra vane gela tāra nikāṭa hoiyā*

"One day Sanātana Gosvāmī came here (to Rādhākuṇḍa) from Vṛndāvana to stay with Śrī Gopāla Bhatta. When he came to the bathingplace (on the northern bank of Śyāmakūṇḍa) named Mānasa Pāvana Ghāṭa (where Śrī Rādhikā daily takes Her bath before worshipping the Sungod) he saw one tiger drinking water there. Raghunātha Dāsa sat there, absorbed in meditation, while the tiger passed him, going into the forest."

*kotokṣaṇe raghunātha cāhe cāri pāne; dekhena śrī sanātana āisen snāne
bhūmite poḍiyā sanātane praṇamīyā; sanātana snehāvaśe ālīngana koilā*

"After a while Raghunātha Dāsa looked in all four directions and saw that Śrī Sanātana had come there for his bath. He fell to the ground to offer his obeisances to Sanātana Gosvāmī, who affectionately embraced him"

*raghunātha prati snehe kohe dhīre dhīre; vṛkṣatala hoite ebe rohībe kuṭīre
jānāīya viśeṣa gosvāmī gelā snāne; kuṭīrera ārambha hoilo sei dine
anya hita hetu raghunātha sei hoite; rahilena kuṭīre gosāira ājñā mate*

"Gently and affectionately Sanātana Gosvāmī told Raghunātha Dāsa: 'Leave the base of this tree now and stay in a hut from now on!' After making this very clear, Sanātana Gosvāmī went for his bath. From that day on the *kuṭīra*-system began (Vaiṣṇavas at Rādhākuṇḍa now live in small cottages instead of in the open air). From then on, for the benefit of others, Raghunātha Dāsa stayed in a hut, on the order of Sanātana Gosvāmī."

14. GOPĪŚVARA MAHĀDEVA IN VṚNDĀVANA

*ki apūrva śobhā ei vanera bhitara; guṇātīta linga rūpa nāma gopīśvara
ei sadāśiva vṛndā-vipina pālaya; ihāke pūjile sarva kārya siddhi hoy
gopīgaṇa sadā kṛṣṇa saṅgera lāgiyā; nirantara pūje yatna nānā dravya diyā
kohite ki pāri ye mahimā gurutara; gopikā pūjita teṅho nāma gopīśvara
indrādi devatā stuti koroye sadāya; vṛndāvane prīti vṛddhi ihāra kṛpāya*

"How wonderful is the beauty of this forest! Here is the transcendental *liṅga-vigraha* named Gopīśvara! This Sadāśiva (the transcendental source of all Śivas) protects Vṛndāvana; anyone who worships Him will be successful in all his duties! The *gopīs* always desired Kṛṣṇa's association, and therefore they always carefully worshiped Gopīśvara with different ingredients. How can I describe His great glories? Because the *gopikās* worship Him, He is called Gopīśvara (master of the *gopīs*). The demigods like Indra always praise Him, and by His grace one's love for Vṛndāvana increases"

*vṛndāvanāvani pate jaya soma soma-
maule sanandana sanātana nāradeḍhya
gopeśvara vraja vilāsi yugāṅghri padme
prema prayaccha nirupādhi namo namas te*

(Viśvanātha Cakravartī's Saṅkalpa Kalpadruma - 103)

"Glory to You, O Lord of Vṛndāvana with the moon-crest! O Gopīśvara, who is worshipable by Sanandana and the four Kumāras, Sanātana Gosvāmī and Nārada Muni! We offer our obeisances unto You! Give us causeless love for the lotusfeet of the two enjoyers of Vraja, Śrī-Śrī Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa!"

15. BHĀṆḌĪRA VANA

This forest lies on the eastern bank of the Yamunā, about 20 km. north of Vṛndāvana. Here was the famous huge Bhāṇḍīra-banyantree which is mentioned in the Purāṇas as being a playground for Kṛṣṇa and His cowherd boys.

*eka dina kṛṣṇa eka bhāṇḍīra talāya; vaṁśī vādya koilo yate jagata mātāya
vaṁśī-dhvani śuni rādhā adhairya hoilā; sakhī saha āsi śīghra kṛṣṇere mililā
hoilo paramānanda donhāra antare; sakhīgaṇa saṅge nānā raṅgete vihāre*

"One day Kṛṣṇa maddened the world by playing His flute at the base of this Bhāṇḍīra-tree. Hearing the sound of the flute, Rādhā became impatient and quickly came here with Her

girlfriends to meet Kṛṣṇa. Both Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa became most happy at heart and began to play here in different ways with Their girlfriends."

*śrī rādhikā kṛṣṇa prati kohe mṛdu bhāṣe; sakhā saha kaiche kṛīḍā koro e pradeśe?
śrī kṛṣṇa kohena - ethā mallaveśa dhari; sakhāgaṇa saha sukhe malla-yudha kori
mora sama malla-yuddha keho nā jānoy; anāyāse kori anya malle parājoy*

"Śrī Rādhikā softly asked Kṛṣṇa: "What kind of games do You play here with Your friends?" Śrī Kṛṣṇa said: 'I dress like a wrestler and blissfully wrestle with My friends here! No one knows how to wrestle like Me! I easily defeat everyone in wrestling!'"

*hāsiyā lalitā kṛṣṇe kohe bāra bāra; mallaveśe yuddha āji dekhibo tomāra
eto kōhi sakalei kōila malla-veśa; kṛṣṇa mallaveśe darpa koroye aśeṣa
kṛṣṇa pāne cāhi rāi manda manda hāse; mallayuddha hetu yuddha sthalete praveśe
mahā malla-yuddhe nāhi jaya parājaya; hoilo ānanda kandarpaera atīśaya*

"Lalitā laughed and told Kṛṣṇa time and again: 'Let me see You fight in that wrestlers dress today! When Lalitā said that, everyone dressed like wrestlers and Kṛṣṇa acted with unlimited pride in His wrestlingdress! Rāi (Rādhikā) slightly smiled while She blinked at Kṛṣṇa and entered the wrestling arena to combat Kṛṣṇa. A great wrestling match then began, in which no one won and no one was defeated, and which greatly delighted Cupid!'"

16. HĀROYĀLA

(Fifth Wave, 1398 - 1403)

The village of Hāroyāla is now named Hāroyāna and is situated about 11 km. west of the town of Kośī.

*dekho kṛṣṇakuṇḍa ei hāroyāla grāma; ethā vilasaye raṅge rāi-ghanaśyāma
pāśā-khelāite rāi kṛṣṇa hārāilā; khelāya hāriyā kṛṣṇa mahā-lajjā pāilā
lalitā kohoye - rāi pāśaka kṛīḍāte; anāyāse tumi hārāilā prāṇanāthe
hoilo tomāra jita aneka prakāra; dekhibo - kandarpa-yuddhe kebā jita hoy
eto kōhi nikuṅja mandire donhe thuiyā; sakhāgaṇa dekhe raṅga alakṣita hoiyā
hoilo paramānanda - kohite ki āra; ei hāroyāla hoy adbhuta vihāra*

"Behold this Kṛṣṇa-kunḍa in this village named Hāroyāla; here Rāi and Ghanaśyāma enjoyed Their pastimes. Here Rāi defeated Kṛṣṇa in a game of dice, greatly embarrassing Kṛṣṇa. Lalitā said: "Rāi! You easily defeated Your Prāṇanātha in this dice-game! You were victorious in so many ways, let us see who will win the battle of Cupid now!" Saying this, she brought Them into a *nikuṅja-mandira* and the *sakhīs* all viewed (Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa's lovegame)

from hidden places. What words can I use to describe that topmost bliss? All these amazing pastimes took place in the village named Hāroyāla!"

17. ŚRĪ ŚUKA-ŚARIKĀ PRALĀPA

The male and female parrots sing Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa's glories in the Śaḍaṅga Medinī Rāga
(Fifth Wave, Verses 2903-2911)

śuka prāha - ṣaḍaṅga medinī gīte yathā :

*jaya janarañjana kañja-nayana ghana añjana nibha nava nāgara ai ai
gokula kulajākula dhṛti mocana candra vadana guṇa sāgara ai ai
nanda tanuja vraja bhūṣaṇa rasamaya mañjula bhuja muda vardhana ai ai
śrī vṛṣabhānutanayā hṛdi sampada madanārbuda mada mardana ai ai*

"All glories to You, O delighter of the people, O lotus-eyed One, O young lover with the lustre of a monsoon cloud or eyeliner! You agitate the daughters of the cowherders of Gokula and release them from their patience, Your face shines like the moon and You are an ocean of virtues! O son of Nanda! O Ornament of Vraja! O Relisher with the beautiful arms! O increaser of bliss! O treasure of the heart of Vṛṣabhānu's daughter! O destroyer of the pride of billions of Cupids!"

*gīta nipuna nidhuvana nayanandita nirupama tāṇḍava-pañḍita ai ai
bhānu tanayā pulināṅgana parisara ramaṇī nikara maṇimaṇḍita ai ai
vaṁśīdhara dharaṇīdhara kṛta bandhura adharāruṇa sundara ai ai
kunda radana kamaṇīya kṛśodara vṛndāvipina purandara ai ai
kṛṣa keli kalahaika dhurandhara dhā dhā dhi dhi tā ga dhennā ai ai
sa sari gari narahari-nātha ei tā iti ai ai a tennā ai ai*

"O expert singer, who enjoys erotic pastimes in Nidhuvana! O peerless dancer! O You who is ornamented (surrounded) by many jewellike girls on the broad bank of the Yamunā, O holder of the flute, holder of the Govardhana Hill with Your beautiful red lips! O You with the beautiful teeth, that resemble Kunda-flowers! O slender hero of Vṛndāvana! O Kṛṣṇa! O Leader in all playful quarrels! O Lord of Narahari! (*dhā dhā dhi dhi tā ga dhennā sa sari gari ei tā iti ai ai a tennā ai ai*)"

*

śarikā prāha - medinī gīte yathā -

*jaya jagata vandinī, vidita nṛpa-nandinī, rādhikā candra vadanī,
duḥka mocanī
śyāma manorañjinī, dhairya bhara bhañjinī, kañja khañjana mīna gañji
mṛga locanī*

"All glories to She who is praised by the whole world, the famous princess Rādhikā with the moon-like face, the destroyer of misery! She enchants Śyāma's mind, destroys His patience and Her eyes defeat the beauty of lotusflowers, wagtailbirds, fishes and does!"

*kānti jita dāminī, parama abhirāminī, bhāminī sindhu-kanyādi mada mardhinī
mañju mṛdu hāsinī, lalita kala bhāṣiṇī, bhuvanamohinī, lalitādi muda vardinī*

"Her lustre defeats the lightning and is most pleasing, She is so powerful that She can destroy the pride of the goddess of fortune and others, She smiles lovely and sweetly, speaks lovely and inarticulate words, She enchants the world and increases the joy of Her friends like Lalitā."

*subhaga śṛṅgāriṇī, nava nava viharinī, vṛndā vipina vinodinī, gaja gāminī.
rāsa rasa raṅgiṇī, madhura taraṅgiṇī, sakala ramaṇī maṇi, narahari svāminī
jhāntā jhām jhāntā tātthā vitakato thunnā ḍṛmiki trigao takatā tā thaiyā,
sari rigama pamaga mana gari sās sāti ai tennā tennā tennām ti tāi ai ā*

"She is beautifully decorated, She plays always fresh pastimes, She rejoices in Vṛndāvana, She walks as elegantly as an elephant, She enjoys the flavours of the Rāsa-dance, She is a river of sweetness, She is the jewel of all women and She is the mistress of Narahari Cakravarti" (*jhāntā jhām jhāntā tātthā vitakato thunnā ḍṛmiki trigao takatā tā thaiyā. sari rigama pamaga mana gari sās sāti ai tennā tennā tennām ti tāi ai ā*).

18. ŚRĪ DĀSA GOSVĀMĪ READS LALITA MĀDHAVA:

*lalita mādhaba - vipralambha sīmā yāte; pūrve diyāchilā raghunāthe āsvādite
grantha pāṭhe raghunātha divā niśi kānde; hoilo unmāda duḥke - dhairya nāhi bānde
kabhu dūre rahe giyā grantha parihari; kabhu bhūme paḍi rahe vakṣe kori
khene khene nānā daśā hoy upasthita; sabe cintāyukta yabe hoyena mūrccita
śrī rūpa gosvāmī mone auśadha vicāri; dāna keli kaumudī varṇilā śiḡhra kori
raghunāthe kohe ihā koro āsvādana; pūrva grantha deho more koribo śodhana*

"(Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī) had previously given Raghunātha dāsa his 'Lalitā Mādhava', in which the limit of love-in-separation is experienced, to relish. When Raghunātha read this book he wept day and night and he became almost mad of misery, unable to remain calm. Sometimes he kept the book far away from himself, and sometimes he fell to the ground, holding it to his chest. While weeping he manifest different conditions of ecstatic love and when he fainted everyone present became very worried. Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī then thought of a medicine that could save Raghunātha's life and he quickly wrote a book named Dāna Keli

Kaumudī (dealing with the meeting of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa)¹, telling Raghunātha: "Why don't you relish this? Give me the book I gave you before back, I have to proofread it still!"

19. MĀ JĀHNAVĀ'S STAY AT RĀDHĀKUṆḌA

Eleventh Wave, verses 150-189

śrī rādhikā kuṇḍa-vāsī śrī dāsa gosāi; śuni harṣa hoilā-colibāre sādhyā nāi (150)
śrī rūpa vicchede sadā adhairyā hṛdaya; annādi vihane deha kṣīṇa atiśaya (151)
niyama nirvāha yaiche ye ceṣṭa antare; se sab dekhite kār hiyā nā vidare (152)

"When, Śrīla Raghunātha dās Gosvāmī, who resided at Rādhikā-kuṇḍa, heard that Mother Jāhnavā had arrived in Vraja, he became very happy— but unfortunately he was unable to go and see her. His heart was always agitated by feelings of separation from Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī and he had given up all solid food. Consequently his body had become greatly emaciated. Whose heart will not break by seeing how he followed all his regulative duties?"

kṛṣṇa dāsa kavirāja ādi bahu jan; praṇami yāite koilo ātma nivedane (153)
gopāla, rāghava paṇḍitādi ek sāthe; cole nandīśvara govardhanādi hoite (154)
sabe vṛndāvane kori īśvarī darśana; jānāilā dāsa gosvāmīra nivedana (155)

"Many great devotees like Kṛṣṇa dāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī went (to Mother Jāhnavā) to offer obeisances to her and surrender themselves to her. Gopāla, Rāghava Paṇḍita and others came together from Nandīśvara and Govardhana to Vṛndāvana to see Jāhnavā Īśvarī. They all told her of Dāsa Gosvāmī's plea."

śrī jāhnavā īśvarīra ye hoilo antare; tāhā vivariyā ke kohite śakti dhare? (156)
śrī gopāla bhaṭṭa ādi gosvāmī sakale; jānāilā-śrī kuṇḍa yāibo prātaḥ kāle (157)
sabe kohe – śrī kuṇḍādi koriyā darśana; śīghra kori ethā koriben āgamana (158)
śrama upāśama hoibek bhālo mate; tabe jāiben ban-bhramaṇa korite (159)

"Who is able to describe the feelings within Śrī Jāhnavā Īśvarī's heart? She told Śrī Gopāla Bhaṭṭa and all the other Gosvāmīs – "Tomorrow morning I will go to Śrī Rādhākuṇḍa." They all replied: "Yes, quickly go to see Śrī Rādhākuṇḍa and other places. After properly resting you can then go on a forest tour of Vraja."

ihā śuni śrī īśvarī ullasita mone; colilen śrī kuṇḍe veṣṭita vijñā gaṇe (160)
śrī kuṇḍete gelen bahulāvana diyā; kuṇḍa śobhā dekhi' preme umaḍaye hiyā (161)
raghunātha dāsa gosvāmīra sthiti yathā; mone ei-tāre giyā dekhiben tathā (162)
śrī dāsa gosvāmī se nirjana kuṇḍa tire; korena śrī nāma grahaṇādi dhīre dhīre (163)

¹¹ That this book was especially written for Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī is proven by a verse that appears in the end of the book, starting with the words *rādhākuṇḍa-taṭi kuṭīra vasatiḥ*.

kṛṣṇa dās kavirāja agrete āsiyā; dāsa gosvāmīra āge chilā dāḍāiyā (164)
avasara pāiyā koroye nivedana; 'śrī jāhnavā īśvarīra hoilo āgamana' (165)

"Hearing this, Śrī Īśvarī (Jāhnavā) was very happy at heart and she went to Rādhākūṇḍa, surrounded by her wise and learned devotees. She went to Śrī Rādhākūṇḍa through Bahulāvana. Seeing the beauty of the *kūṇḍa* her heart was startled with ecstatic love, and she thought: 'Let me go there where Śrī Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī is staying.' Śrī Dāsa Gosvāmī was softly chanting *nāma* on a solitary bank of the *kūṇḍa* when Kṛṣṇadās Kavirāja came before him and told him on the opportune moment: 'Śrī Jāhnavā Īśvarī has come.'"

śuni ki adbhuta prema vyāpilo hṛdaye; āgusari cole āsru yukta netra dvaye (166)
śrī īśvarī dekhe dāsa gosvāmī gamana; atīśaya kṣīṇa tanu, teja sūrya-sama (167)
śrī īśvarī antara bujhite kebā pāre?; jhare dui netre vāri–nivārite nāre (168)

"When Śrī Dāsa Gosvāmī heard this, such a wonderful *prema* pervaded his heart, and he came forward with tear-filled eyes. Śrī Īśvarī saw how Dāsa Gosvāmī walked, how greatly emaciated his body was and how he shone like the sun. Who can understand the heart of Śrī Īśvarī? She could not stop the tears streaming from her eyes."

śrī dāsa gosvāmī praṇamite dhairya dhari; koilo ye ucit premamayī śrī īśvarī (169)
śrī īśvarī āge dāsa gosāi ye koy; tāhā śuni kāra vā nā vidare hṛdaya (170)
mādhava ācārya ādi sabāra sahite; milane adbhuta prema uthalaye cite (171)
ki adbhuta āsru-dhārā sabāra nayane; sakalei sthira hoilen koto kṣaṇe (172)
ārīṭ grāmera vrajavāsī lokagaṇa; sabe harṣa īśvarīra koriyā darśana (173)

"Śrī Dāsa Gosvāmī calmed down and offered his obeisances unto Mother Jāhnavā. Loving Śrī Īśvarī then did what was proper. Whose heart will not break after hearing what Śrī Īśvarī told Dāsa Gosvāmī? Dāsa Gosvāmī's heart also overflowed with astonishing *prema* as he met with all the other devotees, like Mādhava Ācārya. What wonderful streams of tears flowed from everyone's eyes! After a while everyone calmed down. The Vrajavāsīs from Ārīt village (the present Rādhākūṇḍa village) were all very happy to see Jāhnavā Īśvarī."

dina tina cāri rahi śrī rādhākūṇḍete; korilen pāka kriyā parama yatnete (174)
kṛṣṇe bhoga samarpiyā ullāsa antare; bhuñjailā vrajavāsī vaiṣṇava sabāre (175)
prasāda sevane ye ānanda premoday; kebā nā dekhite sādha kore se samaya (176)
śrī jāhnavā īśvarīra alaukika rīti; ki bujhibo? mo chārera nāhi buddhi gati (177)

"She stayed at Śrī Rādhākūṇḍa for three or four days, and very attentively cooked there. With a blissful heart she offered her preparations to Kṛṣṇa and then fed the *prasāda* to all the Vrajavāsīs and Vaiṣṇavas. Who was not fulfilled at that time by seeing the ecstatic love that arose from the service (eating) of this *prasāda*? Who am I to understand the extraordinary activities of Śrī Jāhnavā Īśvarī? The brain of a fool like me cannot conceive of them."

eka dina madhyāhna samaye kuṇḍa tīre; śuni' se vaṁśīra dhvani sthira hoite nāre (178)

kautuka dekhilo se anya agocara; vijñe vistāribo e prasaṅga manohara (179)

tathāpi kōhiye kichu-īśvarī ullāse; vaṁśī-dhvani śuniyā cāhaye cāri pāṣe (180)

"One day at noontime Mother Jāhnavā heard the sound of a flute on the bank of Rādhākuṇḍa and she could not remain calm anymore. She could perceive this curiosity, but others couldn't. Still, for the realised devotees I will recount some of this captivating narration. Hearing the flute-sound, Mother Jāhnavā blissfully looked all around."

kadambēra tale dekhe śyāma cikaniyā; tribhaṅga bhaṅgimā koṭi kandarpa jiniyā (181)

manda manda hāsi' se madhura vaṁśī rāya; ke dhare dhairaya jāte jagat mātāy (182)

śrī rādhikā lalitādi sakhīgaṇa-saṅge; bedhiyāche śyamala sundare mahā raṅge (183)

se adbhuta śobhā dekhi' jāhnavā īśvarī; hoilā mūrccita yaiche kohite nā pāri (184)

"At the base of a Kadamba-tree she saw glossy Śyāmasundara, standing in a threefold bending form, His beauty defeating that of millions of Cupids. Who in the world would not be maddened at the sight of this slightly smiling, sweet flute-player? Very blissfully Śrī Rādhikā, Lalitā and the other *sakhīs* stood surrounding this very playful Śyāmasundara. When Jāhnavā Īśvarī saw this astonishing beauty she fainted in a manner that I cannot describe."

koto kṣaṇe cetan pāiyā sthira hoilā; nirjane e raṅga-ānye prakāśa nā koilā (185)

jāiben śrī govardhanādi darśanete; tāhā jānāilā dāsa gosvāmī agrete (186)

śrī dāsa gosvāmī bhūme poḍi praṇamiyā; dilā anumati dāinye nimagna hoiyā (187)

śunite se dāinya kāra hiyā nā vidare?; ki kohibo īśvarīra ye hoilo antare (188)

paricārikādi madhye jāhnavā īśvarī; kuṇḍa hoite govardhane gelā dhīri dhīri (189)

"After a short while she regained her composure and kept this curiosity to herself, without revealing it to others. Then she went to Śrīla Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī and told him that she was going to have *darśana* of Govardhana and other places. Śrī Dāsa Gosvāmī fell to the ground and offered prostrated obeisances unto her before granting her permission to leave, immersed in an ocean of humility as he was. Whose heart will not break after hearing of this humility? And what can I say to describe Īśvarī's heart? Thus Jāhnavā Īśvarī slowly left Rādhākuṇḍa to go to Govardhana, surrounded by her servants."

Thus ends a selection from Śrīla Narahari Cakravarti's 'Bhakti Ratnākara'.

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